

How the aliens invade

Stowaways

Fleas and other parasites can hitch a ride via animal or human hosts. Rats, mice, and insects can travel hidden in ships' cargo. Some species sneak in when empty cargo ships take on local seawater as ballast, then pump it out at their destination. Every day, large numbers of marine organisms are transported around the globe in this way.



Black rat

Introduced by humans

Some species are deliberately introduced by humans. This can be by hunters, for meat, fur, or sport; by farmers; or for biological control, where a new species is introduced to control native pests. Some invaders are escaped pets, or plants washed out of home aquariums. A few have even been released by immigrants who introduce familiar wildlife to remind them of home!



Cane toad



ABOUT
90 PERCENT
OF THE WORLD'S ISLANDS
HAVE NOW BEEN
INVADED BY RATS